



QMS-005 — Supplier and Contractor Evaluation Policy

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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This policy sets out how Overleaf Publishers Ltd selects, approves, monitors, and reviews suppliers and contractors to ensure that externally provided services and products consistently meet quality, safety, and security requirements. It applies to all third-party providers of goods and services that could affect the quality of the Chainsaw Courses platform, learner safety, or data security. Document reference: QMS-005.

2. SUPPLIER CATEGORIES

CATEGORY (RISK LEVEL)	EXAMPLES
Platform and infrastructure (High — direct impact on availability and security)	Replit (hosting), Vimeo (video), payment gateways
AI and data processing (High — affects content quality and data security)	OpenAI via Replit proxy
Content and subject matter (High — affects safety-critical content accuracy)	NPTC/SME contractors, technical reviewers
Print and fulfilment (Medium — affects product quality and packaging compliance)	Manual printers, postal fulfilment
Professional services (Medium — affects compliance and data handling)	Accountants, legal advisers, IT support
Utilities and office supplies (Low — minimal direct product quality impact)	Energy, stationery, telecoms

3. SUPPLIER APPROVAL PROCESS

No new supplier or contractor may be engaged until the approval process is complete. Steps:

STEP	ACTION
1 — Identify need	Director identifies requirement and defines specification for the required product/service.
2 — Supplier identification	Minimum of two potential suppliers identified and assessed where possible.
3 — Pre-qualification	Supplier completes pre-qualification questionnaire covering: capability, quality management, information security, H&S, environmental policy, and relevant insurance.
4 — Verification	Director verifies: public liability insurance ("e£1M); relevant professional qualifications/certifications; financial stability indicators; references (for high-risk suppliers); and regulatory compliance.
5 — Risk assessment	Supplier risk assessed and classification assigned (see Section 2).



6 — Approval	Director approves supplier for engagement. Approved Supplier Register updated.
7 — Contract / order	Written contract or purchase order issued, including quality, security, and H&S requirements as appropriate to the risk category.

4. SUPPLIER PERFORMANCE MONITORING

Ongoing monitoring is proportionate to supplier risk category:

SUPPLIER TYPE	MONITORING FREQUENCY AND METHOD
High-risk suppliers (platform, AI, content)	Quarterly performance review; SLA compliance check; annual formal evaluation
Medium-risk suppliers	Annual performance review; issue-triggered review as required
Low-risk suppliers	Biennial review or issue-triggered

Performance issues, complaints, or nonconformances involving a supplier are raised as NCs in the Nonconformance Register. Serious or persistent performance failures may result in supplier suspension or removal from the Approved Supplier Register.

5. CONTRACTOR HEALTH AND SAFETY

All contractors engaged by Overleaf Publishers Ltd are required to: provide evidence of appropriate public liability and professional indemnity insurance before commencement; confirm their competence for the specific work; adhere to the organisation's Health, Safety & Wellbeing Policy during their engagement; and report any incident, near-miss, or unsafe condition identified during their engagement.

6. CONTRACTOR INFORMATION SECURITY

Contractors with access to the organisation's systems, data, or learner records are required to: sign a confidentiality and data processing agreement before commencing work; comply with the Information Security Policy and Access Control Policy; report any suspected security incident immediately; and return or securely destroy all data on contract termination.

7. APPROVED SUPPLIER REGISTER

The Approved Supplier Register is maintained by the Director and contains: supplier name; services provided; risk category; approval date; insurance expiry; review date; and performance notes. The Register is reviewed at least annually and at each management review. Suppliers not reviewed within their required review cycle are suspended pending re-evaluation.

For queries: info@chainsawcourses.com · Overleaf Publishers Ltd · Reg. No. 15735226 · VAT 479581629